INCH-POUND

A-A-20198
June 8, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SAUSAGE, POULTRY, RAW OR PRECOOKED, FROZEN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers frozen, raw or precooked poultry (young chicken or young turkey) breakfast sausage, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The product shall conform to each of the options in the following types and styles as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types and styles.

Type I - 1 ounce (28.35 g) link
Type II - 2 ounce (56.7 g) patty

Style A - Raw
Style B - Precooked

Raw materials.

The ingredients used to prepare the poultry breakfast sausage shall be either young chicken or young turkey, salt, brown sugar, breakfast sausage spices and flavorings, and dextrose.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Chief, Standardization Branch, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 3944, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.

FSC 8905

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A. Poultry. All poultry meat used in this product shall be dark meat derived from young chicken (broiler/fryer/roasters) or young turkey and must be in accordance with the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381). No previously frozen poultry or poultry meat may be used in this product. Mechanically deboned (comminuted) and/or finely ground meat shall be excluded from use in this product. Thigh meat used in the product shall be derived from boneless thighs or boneless, skinless thighs.

1. Sampling. Meat, skin, boneless parts, and parts (bone-in) shall be sampled and examined for organoleptic requirements and the defects listed in Table I before formulation or size reduction. The number of samples examined will be those outlined in the applicable U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) Poultry Division acceptable quality level (AQL) sample plan. If any sample does not comply with the organoleptic requirements or has more defects than the maximum tolerance for the AQL sample plan, the product or the lot the sample represents will be rejected for use in this product.

2. Organoleptic requirements. Meat, skin, boneless parts, and parts (bone-in), must be free of rancidity; must be free of fruity, sulfide-like, cardboardy, tallowy, painty, oily, oxidized, metallic, or other off or foreign odors; must show no evidence of mishandling or deterioration; and must have a bright color with no evidence of dehydration or freezing and thawing.

B. Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents.

C. Other ingredients. Brown sugar, dextrose, and breakfast sausage spices and flavorings shall be food grade quality and be approved by the Food and Drug Administration.

TABLE I. Tolerance for defects

Defects
The following defects apply to all categories of meat, skin, and parts (with or without attached skin):
1. A flesh bruise on meat or on a part which exceeds an area equivalent to the area of a circle with a diameter of 0.75 inch (1.91 cm).
2. A part with more than one-third of the meat missing.
3. A defect for skin is the presence of feathers, pinfeathers, diminutive feathers, hair, fatty blubber, spongy fat, and membranes. All or any amount of skin may be missing on a part.

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TABLE I. Tolerance for defects (Continued)

Defects
The following defects apply to all categories of meat, skin, and parts (with or without attached skin): (continued)
4. A defect for discolorations in the meat or skin is when the aggregate area of all discolorations, which are moderate to dark in intensity exceeds an area equivalent to the area of a circle having a diameter of 1.50 inches (3.81 cm).
The following defects apply to boneless meat (with or without attached skin):
5. Bone or bone-like material.
6. Cartilage (gristle), tendon or tendinous material extending more than 0.50 inch (1.27 cm) beyond the meat tissue.
7. Dark colored (due to blood) artery or vein more than 1 inch (2.54 cm) in length.
8. Blood clots which exceed an area equivalent to a circle with a diameter of 0.25 inch (0.64 cm).
9. Thigh meat with more than one-half of the meat missing.

Preparation and processing, Styles A and B.

All preparation and processing described below shall occur subsequent to the date of award. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of USDA. The temperature of ready-to-cook poultry and poultry products, size reduced meat and skin, and the individually frozen poultry sausage products must also comply with 9 CFR Part 381. Fresh chilled poultry, poultry parts, or poultry meat which have been shipped between plants shall be at an internal temperature not higher than 40°F (4.4°C) and not lower than 26°F (-3.3°C) when shipped from the origin plant and when received at the destination plant. The chilled poultry meat and parts must be fabricated into breakfast sausage (raw or precooked) within 7 calendar days after the day the poultry is slaughtered. Within that timeframe, deboned meat and skin from poultry and poultry parts must be fabricated into breakfast sausage within 4 days after deboning. A USDA Poultry Products Grading Certificate or other USDA certification stating class, style, condition, and processing date must accompany each shipment.

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A. Formulation. The poultry sausage shall contain the following ingredients in the amounts as indicated.

Item	Percent	
Skinless dark poultry meat 1/	80.00	minimum
Skin 2/	15.00	maximum
Salt	2.00	maximum
Brown sugar	0.75	maximum
Spices and flavorings	1.75	maximum
Dextrose	0.50	maximum
TOTAL	100.00	

1/ The dark meat component must be comprised of a minimum of 50 percent thigh meat (with or without skin), drumstick meat, and dark trim (at a maximum of 10 percent for the total weight of the dark meat component).

2/ When poultry meat with attached skin is used, a maximum of 10 percent skin will be added.

B. Ground poultry. Poultry thigh meat (with or without skin) shall be ground through a plate with holes not less than 0.125 inch (3.175 mm) nor more than 0.375 inch (9.525 mm) in diameter. The remainder of the meat and skin may be size reduced in accordance with good commercial practices that will result in a ground product with acceptable muscle fibers and texture. Prior to stuffing and forming, the ground product is to be examined for defects as outlined in Section D.

C. Mixing. The remaining ingredients shall be blended with the ground poultry until completely mixed.

D. Processed product requirements. After mixing, the processed poultry product will be examined for organoleptic requirements and tolerance for defects in the fresh state prior to stuffing into links or forming into patties. The frequency of sampling and number of samples examined will be those outlined in the Poultry Division's online AQL sample plan. If any sample does not comply with the requirements in Table II, the product or the production lot the sample represents will be rejected.

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TABLE II. Processed product requirements

	Requirements
Organoleptic requirements:	Must have (1) muscle fibers and a strand-like texture, and (2) a uniform light and bright color with no discolorations or dehydration. Must not have (1) the texture of comminuted meat or skin, (2) a gritty texture, or (3) an emulsified or pasty consistency. Must be free of (1) rancidity and (2) sour, stale, fruity, sulfide-like, cardboardy, tallowy, painty, oily, oxidized, metallic, acidic, or other off or foreign odors.
Tolerance for defects:	Must not contain bone, hard bone-like material, or foreign matter (for example, paper, plastic, rubber, or metal). Must not have more tendons, cartilage (gristle), or tendinous or ligamentous material than the maximum tolerance (exceeding 0.50 inch (1.27 cm) in any dimension).

E. Stuffing and forming. The grinding, formulation, mixing, stuffing and forming, (precooking), individual quick freezing (IQF), and packaging of the poultry sausage links and patties shall be a continuous sequential process. Stuffed and formed poultry sausage links and patties shall be frozen (Style A) by an IQF method, or precooked and frozen (Style B) by an IQF method within 2 hours of the stuffing and forming process.

1. Type I. The blended meat mixture shall be stuffed into edible collagen casings such that the diameter of the finished product is approximately 0.75 inch (1.91 cm) with a raw net weight of 1 ounce (28.35 g) (including casing). Links shall be 3.5 - 4.0 inches (8.89 - 10.16 cm) in length.

2. Type II. The blended meat mixture shall be formed into round or oval patties approximately 0.375 inch (0.953 cm) thick and with a raw net weight of 2 ounces (56.70 g).

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F. Style B, precooking. The product shall be cooked by any method or combination of methods allowed by the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations. An internal product temperature of not less than 160°F (71.1°C) shall be obtained during cooking. When frying is used in the cooking process, no tropical oils are permitted except palm oil. The frying oil must be filtered continuously during the frying process.

G. Reworked product. Raw, wholesome sausage product may be reworked and blended into formulated product at levels established by Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS). Precooked product which is wholesome and salvageable but (1) is misshaped, (2) is fractured (separated into two or more pieces), or (3) does not meet the formed diameter and weight requirements in Section E. may be reworked into raw formulated product at a maximum level of 2 percent provided it is blended in accordance with FSIS procedures, and complies with the organoleptic and defect requirements for raw product in Section D., and with the maximum and minimum formulation requirements in Section A.

H. Finished product requirements.

1. There shall be no foreign material (e.g., dirt, hair, grease, insect parts, metal).

2. There shall be no foreign color, odor, or flavor.

I. Individually quick frozen method. Poultry sausage links and patties shall be frozen by an IQF method in accordance with the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations so that the poultry sausage links or patties do not stick together before packaging and after freezing.

J. Metal detection. The sausage links or patties must be examined by a metal detection device by presenting (a) the links or patties layered, or (b) each package of sausage product or shipping container within the detection field pattern of the device. The frequency of testing will be according to the USDA Poultry Division's online AQL sampling plan for metal detection. The following guidelines do not relieve the contractor of the responsibility to provide a safe product. Sausage product suspected of being contaminated with metal or found to be contaminated with metal will be handled in accordance with FSIS procedures.

1. Metal detection device. The examination must be by: (a) a metal detection device capable of detecting metallic contaminants including, but not limited to, stainless steel shavings, pieces of metal from wire mesh conveyers, pieces of wire, and metal fragments from cutting equipment; (b) a metal detection device approved by FSIS; (c) presenting the sausage products correctly within the detection field pattern of the device; and (d) using procedures appropriate for the dimensions, location, and pattern of the detection field, the

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"orientation effect" and "product effect" on the sensitivity of the device, and the environmental conditions.

2. Examination of sausage. The operating efficiency of the metal detection device will be determined by placing a detection strip with a sphere of 440 stainless steel in the center of the detection field pattern. A detection strip with (a) a 0.0591 inch (1.50 mm) sphere will be used for the examination of layered sausage product, or (b) a 0.1181 inch (3.00 mm) sphere for sausage product examined in a package or in a shipping container. The Poultry Division will provide the detection test strip with the stainless steel sphere of the specified diameter.

K. Freezing. The packaged and packed IQF sausage product must be (1) handled so the sausage products are not stuck together when shipped, and (2) placed in a freezer within 4 hours of packaging and the internal temperature lowered to 0°F (-17.8°C) or lower within 72 hours from the time of entering the freezer. The frozen sausage product shall be held at 0°F (-17.8°C) or below after freezing and the internal temperature shall not exceed 0°F (-17.8°C) at the time of shipment and delivery. Delivery units with internal product temperatures of 1° to 5°F (-17.2° to -15°C) will be tentatively rejected. Tentatively rejected delivery units may be returned to the freezer and the temperature reduced to 0°F (-17.8°C) or lower and reoffered one time only. Delivery units exceeding 5°F (-15°C) or delivery units that have been tentatively rejected and exceed 0°F (-17.8°C) when reoffered will be rejected.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. Delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Products Inspection Acts and regulations promulgated thereunder. Delivered product shall comply with all applicable

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provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the quality assurance for the poultry breakfast sausage shall be determined by the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA in accordance with USDA procedures. The product shall be examined and/or tested for conformance to the product requirements in this CID and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The poultry breakfast sausage shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Packaging (commercial and export).

Type I, packaging. The product shall be packaged in 2 mil plastic film bags in layers one link thick with commercial separation paper or plastic film between layers to a net weight of 10 pounds (4.54 kg). The air shall be exhausted from the bag and the bag closed by heat seal or with a metal or plastic clip or tie.

Type II, packaging. The product shall be packaged in 2 mil plastic film bags to a net weight of 10 pounds (4.54 kg). Commercial patty paper or plastic film must be placed between each patty or layer of patties before packaging. The air shall be exhausted from the bag and the bag closed by heat seal or with a metal or plastic clip or tie.

B. Commercial packing. Four bags shall be packed in containers complying with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of fiberboard boxes. Each box packed with bags shall be provided with a full-height, half-slotted partition, fabricated from the same material as the box. The partition shall divide the box into four equal cells,

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each cell containing one bag. Alternatively, the container may have an integral, full-height partition that divides the interior of the box into two cells of equal volume, each cell containing two bags.

C. Export packing. Four bags of product shall be packed in a snug-fitting, fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Each box packed with bags shall be provided with a full-height, half-slotted partition, fabricated of weather-resistant fiberboard. The partition shall divide the box into four equal cells, each cell containing one bag. Alternatively, the container may have an integral, full-height partition that divides the interior of the box into two cells of equal volume, each cell containing two bags. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

D. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

E. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable. Preparation instructions shall be legibly printed on each package.

F. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Recommended storage temperature shall be legibly printed on each shipping container. In addition, the following precautionary marking shall appear in letters not less than 1 inch high on top of each container:

PERISHABLE - KEEP FROZEN
(0°F (-17.8°C) OR BELOW)

Notes.

Purchasers should specify type(s) and style(s), as appropriate.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Parts 200 to end. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act can be found in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of the CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - SA, MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, FDA, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - PY

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